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The Missing Layer: A Standard for Day-to-Day AI Across GTM

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THE CHALLENGE

An Invisible Tax

AI is being adopted across the org by capable people independently, with no replicable standard to build from.

Signal → Context → Reasoning → Action → Memory

The gap widens as spend climbs, work is duplicated, and dozens of thinkers rebuild similar agents from scratch, running unoptimized processes with no shared definition of what's safe.

A baseline solves for:

01

Ungoverned spend

AI investment scales without visibility into what's being built, what it costs, or what it's returning.

02

Siloed processes

Capable builders across the org duplicate effort, rebuild from scratch, and optimize in isolation.

03

Lack of accountability

When something breaks, there's no clear owner, no audit trail, and no shared standard to return to.

Active Discovery

Mapping what already exists: what compounds, what's duplicated, and where native automation beats an agent.

- **Coverage and substitution** — discovery may reveal some tasks shouldn't use an agent at all, with native automation being cheaper and more auditable for deterministic steps.
- **Reuse by design** — agents aren't built from scratch; skills get added onto baseline templates. The next builder inherits a foundation instead of a blank page.
- **Compliance, security, and knowledge layer** — a baseline inherently creates the governance substrate: consistent permissions, auditable patterns, and captured institutional knowledge.
- **Engineered efficiency** — agent templates can be built token-efficient, call fewer resources, and do more per run when engineered once, centrally, rather than dozens of times, casually.

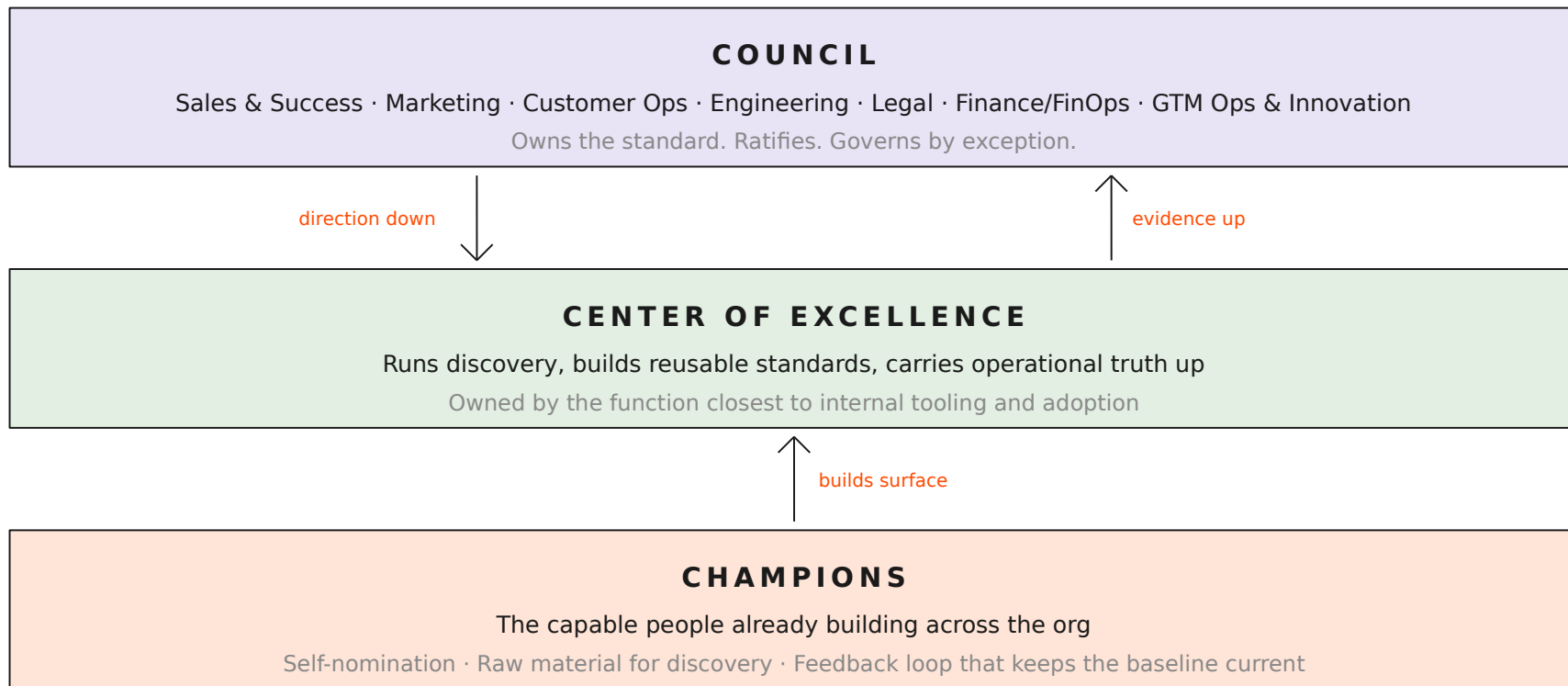
91%

**of enterprises face friction
from AI tool sprawl**

Security concerns, training overhead, lack of centralized oversight, and tools that don't talk to each other.

Zapier Enterprise AI Benefits Survey, Nov 2025
(Centiment, 546 US enterprise leaders at companies with 1,000+ employees)

One Baseline, Owned and Governed



Visibility, Control, Improvement

CHAMPIONS

the builders already at work

- People across the org already building independently; in deals, in content, in ops, in day-to-day activities. Self-nomination and discovery surface the strongest of them. Done right, becoming a champion is a badge of honor.
- Champions' independent builds are the raw material that discovery and process mining draw on to shape agent templates.
- Champions close the feedback loop that keeps the baseline evolving alongside the work.
- Reports what was built, what it replaced, how often it runs, and whether it started from a template or from zero.

CENTER OF EXCELLENCE

where the standard lives

- Owns the agent layer, sitting closest to internal tooling and adoption. Runs discovery through formal process mining and informal collaboration to uncover what's working, what's duplicated, and where native automation beats going agentic entirely.
- Engineers reusable templates, built once, re-skinned per use case, rarely from zero.
- Creates control points from operational reality, owns the dependency-risk documentation, and carries champions into council decisions as a voice.
- Tracks reuse rate per template and cost per run against native automation.

COUNCIL

governs by exception

- A multidisciplinary sign-off body with balanced authority: Sales & Success, Marketing, Customer Ops, Engineering, Legal, Finance/FinOps, and GTM Ops & Innovation.
- Owns the standard: data, shared context, safety guardrails, and a single definition of good. It ratifies what the CoE proposes rather than designing blind.
- Provides visibility into the decisions that matter and control at the right moments, preventing the bottlenecks that stifle innovation.
- Sees coverage against the org's footprint, spend against budget, incident count and time to a named owner, and exceptions granted.

A System That Compounds

Accountability and interoperability
are clearly owned across every function.

Standardization as a home for improvement
owned IP compounds and outlasts any single builder.

Cost and efficiency become visible together
as time-to-value shrinks and outcomes become readily quantifiable.

10x

Organizations with formal AI measurement processes are 10x more likely to report new AI-driven revenue.

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A separate finding: McKinsey's State of AI (Aug 2026, 1,719 respondents, 97 nations) found high performers are twice as likely as others to report strong leadership commitment to AI and defined processes to measure its impact.